ImWeb workshop — a sheet for the person running the room

ImWeb is a video instrument that runs in a web browser. It takes live camera, movies and generated images, and mixes them through a chain of effects into one picture. It continues *Image/ine*, the instrument Tom Demeyer and Steina Vasulka made at STEIM in Amsterdam in the 1990s.

Where: https://imweb.image-ine.org — nothing to install, free.

Before the session

- **Browser:** Chrome, Edge or Brave on a laptop made in the last five years. Safari works too.
- **Camera:** each student allows the camera when the browser asks. The picture is much richer with a camera than without one.
- **Sound (optional):** a microphone lets the picture react to sound. Headphones stop twenty laptops feeding back into each other.
- **Try it yourself first** for ten minutes, ideally with the Tutorials below. The first screen offers three ways in; pick **Learn step by step**.
- **Projector (optional):** one laptop on the projector so the room can watch while you demonstrate.

A 90-minute plan

Time	What happens
0–10	**Show, don't explain.** On the projector, open ImWeb and choose **Explore the Looks**. Press the number keys 0–9: each is a finished *Look* (a saved setting of the whole instrument). Let the room call out which ones they like.
10–25	**Everyone opens it.** Allow the camera, choose **Explore the Looks**, and play with the number keys. Then: pick one Look, and change *one* thing in it by dragging a value sideways in the panel on the right.
25–55	**Tutorials.** Press **Shift+G** (or choose *Learn step by step*), then the **Tutorials** track. Everyone does *Tutorial 0 — a picture in sixty seconds*, then picks a theme: **Feedback**, **Audio**, **3D** or **Time**. Each tutorial makes one thing in about five moves, and **Load starting point** gives everyone the same start.
55–75	**Make one Look of your own.** Start from a Look or a tutorial and change it until it is yours. Press **Shift+S** to save it into a tile along the bottom.
75–90	**Show and tell.** Two or three students put their Look on the projector and say what they changed.

The moves everyone needs

Do this	To
0–9	Recall a saved Look
Shift+S	Save the current picture as a Look
Drag a value **sideways**	Change it
Double-click a value	Put it back to its default
⌘-click (Ctrl-click on Windows) a value	Type a number
Right-click a value	Give it a controller: an LFO, the microphone, MIDI…
⌘K	Find any control by name
q / a / z	Change the Foreground / Background / Displacement source
f	Full screen
?	Every keyboard shortcut

When something goes wrong

- **The picture is black.** Press **s**: if a yellow **SOLO** shows in the status bar, Solo is bypassing the effects. Otherwise recall a Look with a number key.
- **Everything went strange and you want to start over. Shift+Esc** resets every value to its default. **⌘⇧0** recalls the neutral State.
- **No camera.** The browser blocked it. Click the camera icon in the address bar, allow it, and reload the page.
- **It runs slowly.** Close other tabs, and in *Output ▸ Display & Record* set a smaller display size. Some Looks are heavier than others.
- **A student's work disappeared.** Looks are saved in that browser on that laptop. To keep them, use **⌘S** to save a project file (`.imweb`) and open it again later with **⌘O**.

Afterwards

The author would like to know where students got stuck — that shapes what gets fixed next. The observation sheet that comes with this one is a simple way to collect it. Send notes, or just a few sentences, to Haraldur Karlsson — or post them at https://github.com/imweb-project/ImWeb/discussions.

Manuals, the full keyboard list and *Try This First — 10 minutes* are in the **?** menu inside the app.